

If the scientists say it's not possible, get me another set of scientists

(Dowding on Chain Home radar, ca. 1937)

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Dedicated to the memory of Air Chief Marshal Hugh Caswall Tremenheere Dowding (1st Baron Dowding), president of the Tunbridge Wells branch of the Flying Saucer Club; reportedly a member of the Fairy Investigation Society and the Ghost Club.

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Scope and Definitions

- **UAP:** Unidentified Anomalous Phenomena.
- **NHI:** Non-human intelligence(s).
- **Disclosure:** Formal acknowledgment by a globally significant authority (e.g., UN Secretary-General or U.S. President) of NHI presence on Earth.
- **Evidence vs. conjecture:** I label archival records as *evidence*, public reporting as *claims*, and technical ideas as *hypotheses/speculation*.
- **Scope:** Methods and institutions first; physics possibilities second; neither presumes empirical confirmation of any specific case.

Motivation and Stance

- **Motivation:** Curiosity about rapid, potentially superluminal, interstellar travel (“the Drive”) and whether anomalous observations can inform new physics and measurement.
- **Stance:** I am not an experimenter; any personal observations (e.g., a Tic Tac-shaped object in cloudy skies) are treated as anecdotal and non-probative.
- **Background:** First read the Condon Report (UCB library, 1984); the executive summary conveyed a “no worries, almost nothing to see here; if true, relax” message unavailable to me earlier in Austria.
- **Focus:** Propulsion concepts and interfaces that, if real, could hugely accelerate scientific progress—indeed, might first obliterate and then revolutionize large branches of science.

Disclosure and Working Hypothesis

- **Disclosure:** “Disclosure” denotes formal acknowledgment by a globally significant authority of NHI presence on Earth.
- **Working hypothesis (provisional):** NHIs are extraterrestrial, may operate from bases on or near Earth, and human civilization may be unknowingly embedded within a larger galactic-scale civilization.
- **Caveat:** Many methodological and institutional points hold even if this hypothesis is false.

Three Messages (Preview)

- ① **Expected value of inquiry:** Even with low priors, potential payoff justifies bounded, rigorous, and open investigation of UAP.
- ② **Paradigm humility:** Anomalies may not fit current conceptual images and metaphors; pluralism, careful measurement, and falsification are essential.
- ③ **Institutions shape knowledge:** Classification, incentives, and geopolitics determine what can be known; build transparent, international, civilian-led infrastructure.

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A Pragmatic Framework for UAP Inquiry

- **State of theory:** General Relativity and Quantum Theory remain conceptually distinct; unification is unsettled. Advanced science could help!
- **Extraordinary claims:** Low priors require strong evidence (Sagan/Bayesian view). The burden of proof lies with the claimant (Russell's Teapot).
- **Expected value:** The potential huge payoff to physics and technology can justify bounded, rigorous investigation despite “very low” priors.
- **As-if reasoning:** Following Vaihinger, explore “as-if” models to test what would follow if certain claims were true—a common scientific practice.

Conceptual Images (Hertz)

- **Hertz's view:** The conceptual core of physical theories are “images” of our mind whose logical consequences mirror nature's consequences.

“We form for ourselves images or symbols of external objects; and the form which we give them is such that the necessary consequents of the images in thought are always the images of the necessary consequents in nature of the things pictured. ... we do not know ... whether our conceptions of things are in conformity with them in any other than this one fundamental respect.”

- **Non-convergence:** Successive images need not converge ontologically.

Gravity:

epicycles (Ptolemy)

→ force (Newton)

→ curvature (Einstein)

→ ?

Implication:

Future images may reframe
phenomenology without vindicating
current images and metaphors.

Evaluating Images: Lakatos and Opacity

- **Lakatos:** Research programs characterized by their respective images are progressive or degenerative; early phases can appear degenerative due to immature auxiliaries and scarce data; late degenerative phases can appear progressive due to a shielding by auxiliary constructions.
- **Opacity principle (Quantitative Clarke's Law):** Without explanatory transfer (an “NHI Prometheus”), technologies more than one conceptual “image” ahead are largely opaque to outsiders.
- **Example:** Post-WWII German technologies were assimilated quickly because the underlying images were similar and Nazi experts (via *Operation Paperclip*) were willing to explain it.

Methodology for UAP Investigation

- **Avoid overconfidence:** Prevailing models may not span all possibilities; assess claims against multiple images. Be wary of narcissism, ego-investment and the Dunning-Kruger effect: experts tend to “over-sell” their own pet theories.
- **Learning goals:** Identify physically allowable capacities implied by credible observations. For instance, seemingly impossible acceleration is no issue if inertia can be modified or even nullified.
- **Pluralism and testing:** Embrace methodological anarchy by exploring diverse research avenues (Feyerabend), then impose rigorous order through falsifiable experiments and critical pruning (Popper)—a cycle of creative chaos yielding to disciplined refinement, much like psychosis giving way to lucidity through neurotic rigor.

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What is Inertia?

- **GR's core:** Inertial and gravitational mass are linked by the Equivalence Principle.
- **Key question:** If this linkage can be manipulated (reduced, enhanced, or effectively inverted), some reported UAP kinematics become less paradoxical.
- **Analogy:** The “inserter” in control theory attenuates motion; an inverse analogue suggests “negative impedance” behavior—an intuition for negative inertia, mass or anti-gravity (AG), not a claim.

Speculative Mechanisms (My Own Pet Hypotheses)

- **Inertia pathways:**
 - Higgs mechanism and interaction energy (e.g., gluons, photons) contribute to inertia; modifying couplings could modify effective inertia or mass.
- **Vacuum effects (lab-scale):**
 - Casimir effect: boundary conditions reduce vacuum fluctuations which in turn reduce mass.
 - Scharnhorst effect: reduced vacuum polarization between plates can yield superluminal phase velocities (no usable signaling).
- **Structured spacetime:**
 - Hypotheses about “holes” or fractal-like structures might imply effective shortcuts by traversing “less” spacetime—a craft could be “hopping” through spacetime gaps—during geodesic motion. Could such a structure emerge from nonlinear processes?

Caution: On the Use of “Quantum”

- **Avoid gray boxes:** “Quantum” is not a catch-all; specify mechanisms and predictions. It is often used as a hocus-pocus box for wishful thinking.
- **Entanglement:** Encodes relational, not individual, properties; respects no-signaling; cannot transmit controllable information instantaneously. Popular misuse to explain psy phenomena ignores its core properties.
- **Implication:** Claims invoking “quantum” should be tied to models with clear, falsifiable implications.

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Private Funding of Anti-Gravity Research

- **Claim:** Noble sponsors (nomen nescio)
- **Evidence:** Postwar private initiatives included support from Roger Babson and Agnew Bahnson (see Kaiser & Rickles).
- **Claim:** Reports of a private initiative funded by the owner of Church's Texas Chicken. Personnel reportedly included Yakir Aharonov, Hal Puthoff, with brief involvement by Danny Greenberger (former NSA).
- **Note:** Attribution and documentation vary; treat as claims unless primary sources are available.

USAF Involvement and “Going Dark” (Claim)

- **Evidence:** AIP oral histories:
 - Joshua Goldberg: Recalls being hired at Wright-Patterson AFB because an officer believed an “anti-gravity device” was the next big thing. Confirms USAF was funding general relativity research in the late 50s/early 60s.
 - Louis Witten: Received a “cost-plus” contract from the USAF while at the Research Institute for Advanced Studies, a think tank established in 1955 by the Glenn L. Martin Company; Air Force interest in the mid-1950s.
- **Claim:** Private speculation on USG efforts by Australian government physicist Harry Oliver Turner.
- **Evidence:** Mansfield Amendment (1969): Required military-funded research to have direct/clear military relevance; likely reshaped funding portfolios.
- **Hypothesis:** Some gravity/AG lines may have moved into more restricted channels post-1969.

Legacy Programs: Definitions and Custodianship (Claims)

- **Claim: Definition (as alleged):** Highly secret, compartmented programs. A “member” has direct physical access to NHI-related materials (craft, biologicals, or artifacts).
- **Claim:** James T. Lacatski is the only public figure to date who has stated involvement in such a program.
- **Claim: Custodianship (as reported):** CIA’s Directorate of Science and Technology (DS&T) as portfolio manager; CIA’s Office of Global Access (OGA) for retrieval logistics.
- **Implication:** This operational structure makes past and present Deputy Directors of these departments the primary gatekeepers.

Historical Precedent: Chadwell (OSI, 1952)

- **Evidence:** Marshall Chadwell (OSI) on British activity related to “UFOs”:
During the day, a “perfect flying saucer” was seen by these officials as well as RAF pilots. This is disturbing to Jones (a WWII radar expert) because he realizes that the creation or correction of public opinion is part of his responsibilities.
- **Implication:** Government attention included both technical assessment and information management, with the US seeking to align allied efforts.
- **Open question:** If even Britain needed coordination and (re)alignment, what about, say, the WWI & WWII losers Germany or Austria?

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Hypothetical: A UAP Incident taking place anywhere in the world

- **Hypothesis:** An extraction operation would likely be initiated within hours by military/security services—e.g., CIA-led OGA team with Joint Special Operations Command (JSOC) component, with pre-existing local liaisons, thereby bypassing unreliable and unforeseeable civilian political channels.
- **A Stark Warning to Civilian Witnesses:** For the sake of survival, leave ASAP, and get out of anybody's way. There may be multiple conflicting extraction parties involved; you don't want to mingle!
- **Open question:** How can civil research proceed when access is constrained by enforced secrecy and extraordinary privileged extraction procedures where “all gloves are off”?

Geopolitics and the State of Exception

- **Claim:** Since WWII, elements of a permanent “state of exception” (Schmitt; Agamben) may periodically shape decision-making on UAP and related matters, suspending normal rules.
- **Thucydides’ Melian Dialogue as a Metaphor:** The empire takes what it needs, while the colonies (or allies) suffer what they must.
- **Question:** What does this mean for international partners (e.g., Europe) and scientific collaboration, who may be viewed as potential adversaries in this context?

A Core Dilemma of Disclosure: Autonomy

- **Autonomy:** Do we, as a society or species, possess the autonomy to decide on disclosure—legally, institutionally, or practically? Or is that choice no longer ours?
- **Hypothesis: Containment:** If NHIs perceive risk from unconstrained human expansion, they might share limited knowledge while at the same time pursue containment, by withholding key propulsion details (“the Drive”). Because if we could effortlessly travel to them, we might cause inconveniences.

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A Utopian Path Forward (If We Can Choose)

- **Utopian Strategy:** Adopt an Open Access approach, fostering dialogue between all relevant parties, including the US, Russia, and China. This may also involve consultation with NHI presence, if feasible.
- **Guiding Principle wrt Fear of Disclosure:** The Enlightenment sought to eliminate fear with rationality. Duke Dracula was overcome by science; so will be the fear of disclosure.
 - A quote by Immanuel Kant, 1784 (in “Was ist Aufklärung”):
Enlightenment is a person's emergence from self-imposed immaturity (selbstverschuldeten Unmündigkeit). . . . Sapere Aude! [Latin translated: Dare to know, from Horace]. Have courage to use your own mind! Thus is the motto of Enlightenment.
 - A quote by Sigmund Freud, 1930 (in “Das Unbehagen in der Kultur”):
Wo Es war, soll Ich werden.—Where id was, there ego shall be.

Three Messages (Reprise)

- ① **Expected value of inquiry:** Even with low priors, the potential payoff justifies bounded, rigorous, and open investigation of UAP.
- ② **Paradigm humility:** Anomalies may not fit current images; pluralism, careful measurement, and falsification are essential.
- ③ **Institutions matter:** Classification, incentives, and geopolitics shape knowledge; prioritize transparent, international, civilian-led research.

Thank You for Your Attention

Slides: [ORCID profile](#)